ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

A Higher and Holier Fast

Elder Ulisses Soares · October 2026 general conference

Weekly 25-minute meeting (since Sept. 6, 2026). Begin and end with prayer, start the discussion quickly, and counsel together during the lesson. There is no separate counseling topic beforehand.

ONE CORE TRUTH

Fasting with intentional prayer is worship that draws heaven near.

0:00–2:00 — **Welcome & prayer · Presidency**

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00 — **Open · Teacher**

- Ask: Is my fast a skipped meal or an act of worship with a clear purpose?
- Invite someone to read: “A sincere and faithful fast is accompanied by earnest and intentional prayer.”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00 — **Discuss one core truth · Everyone**

- Q1. Read Isaiah 58:6 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00 — **Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher**

- From the talk: Ponder Isaiah's teachings and embrace the law of the fast more intentionally as worship.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00 — **Closing prayer · Presidency**

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

BEFORE SUNDAY

The Lord's call to fast echoes Isaiah, with promised blessings of light after darkness, healing, and assurance that He is near. A sincere fast is accompanied by earnest, intentional prayer, and finds its highest expression in Jesus Christ. Fasting is an act of worship that refines discipleship and prepares us for revelation; fast offerings help “let the oppressed go free.”

- Read the full talk and pray about what your quorum or Relief Society needs from it.
- Share the talk link a few days early so members come having read it.
- Teach one truth well. Meaningful discussion matters more than covering everything.
- Other scriptures the talk cites: Isaiah 58:1–7; Isaiah 58:8–9; Helaman 3:35; Alma 7:11, 12

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.